of ineffective Indians to show to the world that they have represen-

tatives of the Indian community in the government.

R&AW Chief Verma and his spies were troubled by the last paragraph of this two decade-old note. This paragraph said:

Fijians insist, obviously inspired and supported by the European community, that they have a special position in these Islands as compared with the Indian community and this position should be respected by the others, particularly by the majority Indian community. In other words, the European and Fijian obviously feel justified in whatever they do on the implicit basis that they are the owners and proprietors of Fiji and the Indian community which was here originally as indentured labour force, should be content to go on working for the proprietors on most favourable terms that could be secured.

Shekhawat told me he had been surprised by the reports. Whatever little he had read about Fiji in the mid-1980s had spoken of a multiracial society living in harmony. He went through another report which indicated that the trouble had started brewing just before the independence of Fiji in October 1970. Drafted in July 1970, the report said that some Muslim organisations had criticised the framework of the future constitution that was being deliberated between Fiji's Ratu Mara and the British government in London. The report sent to India's then foreign secretary T.N. Kaul as well as K. Natwar Singh, who was a director in the Prime Minister's Office (PMO), highlighted the Fiji Muslim Political Organisation's demand for separate representation for Muslims in the new parliament.

The comments on the margins of the intelligence note said: